

Nick Heindl

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Tech Designer and Accessibility Champion

Nick has an infectious passion for learning and empowering creative teams. He is consistently relied upon to jump into new areas to diagnose, triage, and firefight issues. Previous leads have used the following terms to describe Nick and his impact, “Force Multiplier”, “Advocate”, “Mentor”.

With a background in tech design and gameplay engineering, Nick’s latest position had him combine this technical expertise and love of inclusive design to form a new team dedicated to ensuring a AAA MMORPG, made with a new IP and technology stack, would be accessible from Day 1.

Selected Professional Experience

ZeniMax Online Studios (Xbox, Bethesda)

August 2021 – Present

Principal Technical Designer and Accessibility Team Lead

Unannounced AAA MMORPG (350+ devs)

New ECS-based engine, AngelScript, C++, C#, Visual Script (like Blueprint)

- Founded and led a new Accessibility Team
- Technical Product Owner of Narrative Systems from first implementation to alpha
- Prototyped various features, including first example of RPG Choice & Consequence
- Collaborated with various teams to address technical blockers early and ensure alignment
- Triage and prioritized bugs and workflow issues with stakeholders to maximize dev efficiency
- Wrote utility libraries, dev tutorials, tests, and exemplar content to empower other scripters
- Created script review process, best practices, and tool workflows for users across disciplines
- Performed technical evaluations and breakdowns of third-party software
- Onboarded and trained multiple tech designers; Mentored many designers across departments

PUBG Corporation

October 2020 – July 2021

Software Engineer

PlayerUnknown’s Battlegrounds (PUBG)

Unreal Engine 4, C++, PowerShell

- Bolstered a new remote workflow with git and p4 to support non-technical staff
- Assisted Tech Director with setting up a new recruiting and interviewing process
- Engineering feature owner for new vehicles as part of an unreleased map

Raven Software (Activision Blizzard)

Summer 2015 – October 2020

Gameplay Engineer

Call of Duty: Warzone, Modern Warfare, Cold War, Black Ops IIII, Online (China only)

3+ proprietary engines, C++, Custom Script Language (GSC), Lua

- Led small team to design, architect, and implement Warzone’s Ping Marker system
- Prototyped, polished, and shipped many features and game modes for a worldwide audience
- Designed & built player ranking system; Used live metrics to tune rewards
- Built an automated testing tool to assist Design and QA on CoD’s first Battle Royale
- Profiled code and established standards to reduce live service errors by tenfold
- Engineering mentor to interns and folks in many departments (Eng./Design/QA)